



Why You? Why Now?

When contemplating starting your own business, it is wise to do some self-assessment first. Take time to weigh your strengths and weaknesses and consider whether you are ready to be your own boss.

Why you?

Starting your own business is an exciting opportunity, but it is essential to be practical from the beginning. Before making any decisions, ask yourself some key questions. First and foremost, do you have a realistic business idea, and do you have the drive and energy to bring it to fruition? Also, do you have the necessary skills to develop your idea, and if not, could you acquire them? If the answer to these questions is no, that does not mean you will never start your own business, just not the one you are thinking of now.

Assessing yourself

Being your own boss requires a wide range of abilities, many of which you will need at the outset. Take time to identify the transferable skills you know you have—plus other talents you could develop—that would be useful for the business. Also consider the skills friends and family may be able to offer you. Conversely, scrutinize yourself, looking for areas of weakness, and think of ways you can overcome them.

Running a business is a long-term commitment, so working in a field that interests you is important. However, you need to be confident that your interest is strong enough to last the duration of the business.

Your strengths

Think about all the personal strengths you can bring to the business, including:

- › **Professional skills**, such as managing people, creating budgets, negotiating, and dealing with clients.
- › **Academic abilities** may include numeracy, language skills, and artistic abilities.
- › **Personal characteristics**, such as energy, determination, curiosity, and creativity.

